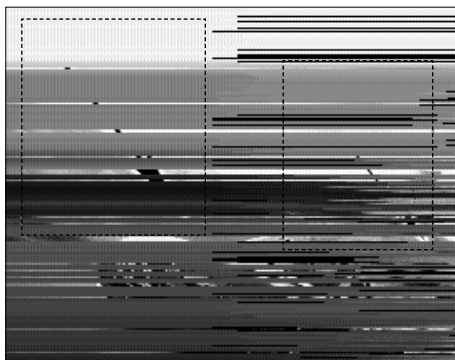


3.1 The Marquee Tools

The Marquee tools  (Shortcut: [M], [Shift] + [M] to cycle between rectangular and elliptical) are the most basic selection tools—you can make rectangular, elliptical or single-pixel row and column selections.

3.1.1 Drawing Selections With The Marquee

When you choose the Marquee tools, you will see that the cursor has turned into a crosshair. Click and drag this cursor to start making your selection. By default, you will draw the selection box from its corner—that is, the point that you click and start dragging from will become one of the corners of the selection. If, however, you would like to draw the box from the centre, hold down [Alt] before you click.



Begin selections from a corner by default (left) or hold down [Alt] to draw selections from the centre (right)

To draw a perfect square or circle, hold down [Shift] before starting your selection with the rectangular or elliptical marquee respectively. If you'd like to move the selection boundaries around while you're drawing it, hold down the spacebar—the selection will temporarily stop drawing, and moving the mouse will now change the position of the selection till you let go of the spacebar.

If you've already made a selection and want to add to it, hold down [Shift] and then select the area you want to add. On the other hand, use [Alt] to subtract areas from your existing selection.